

Scott Kellum

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To the hiring committee

Thank you for the opportunity to apply for the Lead Product Designer, BuzzFeed Island role. I am excited about the ideas behind BuzzFeed Island. A vision for social media that feels more social and more human and values the time people spend with it instead of commoditizing that time. The goals outlined in The Anti-SNARF Manifesto resonated with me, as did the work I have been doing on social projects recently. I'm excited about where this new generation of social platforms is going, and I hope to be a part of BF Island.

As the CEO and founder of Typetura, I worked with clients at A New Social and WeDistribute to explore how people connect with others in a post-meta, post-Twitter world. With A New Social, I helped visualize "constellations," or the networks of social media platforms people use, helping people connect regardless of platform. Additionally, with WeDistribute, I designed branding and a website to highlight the evolving social media landscape, tying content and reporting to new social experiences and technologies.

At Mariana Tek, I led platform design projects through research, prototyping, testing, and development. While developing designs and working toward implementation, I gained a deep understanding of a wide range of client and customer needs. As a result of this work, the company grew from a small startup serving boutique fitness to being acquired by Xplor, a multinational group with interests throughout the services space.

I genuinely love how social media can bring people together while sharing your frustration with how it drives us apart. I'm excited about the transformative power of AI and ML to augment humanity, not replace it. BuzzFeed and Huffington Post have consistently represented some of the best of the internet and internet culture. I'm thrilled that you are working on a social media platform, and I would be delighted to bring my deep experience and passion to work with your team.

Warm regards,
Scott Kellum